

Monaco

Ratio: 4:5 **Adopted:** April 4, 1881 **Usage:** National and Civil

The bicolor design is common on other national flags, for example San Marino. It is often used as a background for heraldic livery



Red and white are the heraldic colors of the Grimaldi family

Europe



The Grimaldis, a Genoese family, have ruled **Monaco** since the 13th century. Until 1860, the principality was considered part of Italy.

The present bicolor design was adopted in 1881 under Prince Charles III. It is identical to the far younger Indonesian national flag except in its statutory proportions which are 4:5, compared to 2:3.

The Grimaldi coat of arms, which appears on the state flag, is the traditional one of the princely family

and consists of a shield supported by two monks bearing swords.

The device alludes to the legend of 1297, in which the Grimaldis conquered Monaco after entering the city with soldiers disguised as monks. Earlier Monegasque flags incorporated the Grimaldi shield and crown on a white field.

ARMS OF GRIMALDIS

*The Grimaldi motto—
Deo Juvante
("With God's Help")*



A princely crown

*The collar of the
Order of St. Charles
surrounds a shield of
red and white (or silver)*